PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
prepared & empowered

PARENT NOTIFICATION LETTER FOR INITIAL ELIGIBILITY PLACEMENT IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM

To the Parents of:_____ Date:_____

School: _____ Grade:_____

Date of Birth:_____ Student ID#:_____

When you enrolled your child in school this year, you noted on the Language Use Survey that he or she may use a language other than English. Based on this response, the law requires us to test your child's English language proficiency - speaking, listening, reading, and writing - to determine if s/he is legally entitled to English Language Development (ELD) support services. We used this test to determine the best educational program placement for your child. We are required to inform you of the test results, our program recommendation, and all of the placement options available for your child within 30 days of your child's enrollment or the start of the school year. Our recommendation appears below, along with details about our district's ELD program and information our school district uses to determine when a student is ready to exit the ELD program.

Based on your child's test result we have determined your child's eligibility. Further assessment and programming decisions will be informed by the Family and Educational History and completed at your child's school.

☐ Your child is eligible for ELD support services - Intensive English Language Development (IELD).

☐ Your child is eligible for ELD support services - Cognitive Academic Language Support (CALS).

☐ Your child is eligible for ELD support services at the Pre-Kindergarten level.

☐ Your child is NOT eligible for ELD support services.

☐ Other: _____

This recommendation is based on the following criteria as marked below:

☐ 1. WIDA-Online Screener Score: _____

☐ 2. Family and Educational History

☐ 3. Other Assessments:

Test: _____ Score: _____

Test: _____ Score: _____

Additional direct English language instruction is instrumental in increasing a student's English language proficiency and ability to acquire grade-level academic content. The methods of instruction are intensive English language development, content-based English instruction and Academic English support, all of which are provided by certified ESOL teachers. We highly recommend that your child participate in and receive the benefits from an ELD program. The overall goal of the ELD program is for students to become fully proficient in English and to master state standards for academic achievement as rapidly as possible.

On average, research has shown that students will reach proficiency within 6 years of being identified as a Multilingual Learner and receiving English Language Development Services. The expected 4-year rate of high school graduation from Portland schools for Multilingual students is 53% and for Multilingual students who have exited is 65%. The 6-year high school graduation rate is 66% for Multilingual students and 77% for Multilingual students who have exited. However, factors such as a student's disability, prior education and native language literacy may influence that timeline. In the case of a child with a disability, the ELD Services will be designed to help meet the student's Individual Education Plan. ***To exit from ELD support services, your child has to reach a composite score of Level 4.5 on ACCESS for ELLs or the ALT ACCESS***.

As mentioned, we highly recommend that your child participates in and receives the benefits from this program, however, you have the right to decline your child's participation in or unenroll your child from ("opt your child out") the ELD program or particular ELD services at this time or at any time during the school year. Please contact your child's teacher if you would like to schedule a parent conference to discuss your child's options for program placement and/or if you wish to opt your child out of the ELD program or particular ELD services within the ELD program.

Programming changes, as a result of your child's progress, will be communicated to you through the school's Language Assessment Committee (LAC) process at least once a year or as needed. Ongoing academic progress will be reported to you regularly by your child's classroom teacher(s). We highly encourage you to check in with your child's teacher about your child's progress anytime.

Sincerely,

Carlos Gomez
Director of ESOL - Elementary

Theresa Lee
Director of ESOL - Secondary

Original: Student Cumulative Folder
Copy: Parent
P120- ENG Initial Eligibility Updated 11.13.24